The later ***Nyaya*** realist philosophers analyse the object of cognition into some subject (*visheshya*) that has a property (*visheshana*), the two being held together by a relation. An experience is true when the structure of its content (*vishayata*) mirrors or corresponds to that of the objective situation. Error most typically occurs when the modifier in the cognition (*prakara* corresponding to the *visheshana* in the object) is not actually related to the subject in the current perceptual situation.

Further reading: G. Bhattacharya 1989; Matilal 2002b; Mohanty 1966 and 1992

Pramana: a reliable method for gaining knowledge. The majority of Indian philosophers recognise sense perception (***pratyaksha***), inference (***anumana***) and verbal testimony (*shabda*) as *pramanas* in their own right. Most hold that beliefs are justified and true if they are formed by a process that generally produces true beliefs. (For example, perceptual beliefs are justified if they come about via sensory stimulation from objects in the environment. They are not justified if they are produced by hallucination, which is not a reliable mechanism.) ***Kumarila***'s view (in which he is followed by most ***Vedanta*** thinkers) that a *pramana* provides new information by revealing something previously not known to be the case was very influential. The primary reliable instrument of knowledge is sensory perception. Information from perception supplies the data for inferences. Testimony includes the word of experts and whatever one accepts as scripture. The materialist ***Carvakas*** accept only sense perception; Buddhists accept only perception and inference; the ***Samkhyas*** accept perception, inference and testimony; the *Naiyayikas* accept perception, inference, testimony and comparison (*upamana*); the *Prabhakaras* in the ***Purva Mimamsa*** tradition accept perception, inference,